CIRC HQ STUDENT HANDOUT | GRADES 5 AND 6

Outdoor Microclimate Map

Goal: Compare conditions across outdoor classroom zones and recommend where different learning activities should happen.

35 minutes | 9 steps | Engineering and Design | Playbook A meeting 30, on-track choice

Ask | Plan | Build | Test | Improve

You are done when

Point to two mapped zones and defend one activity recommendation with evidence.

You will use

- Clipboards
- Outdoor zone map
- Pencils
- Thermometers if available
- Wind ribbons
- Observation key
- Indoor weather data cards

Steps

35 minutes total. Your teacher says when to move on.

1 Step 1: Get ready — 3 min

- Clip the zone map to your board.
- Check your assigned zones.

2 Step 2: Walk out — 2 min

- Walk with your weather team.

3 Step 3: Use tools safely — 3 min

- Carry the thermometer by its case.
- Leave unknown plants untouched.
- Stay inside each marked zone.

4 Step 4: Observe two zones — 8 min

- Mark sun or shade.
- Mark the surface condition.
- Watch the wind ribbon.

5 Step 5: Take readings — 6 min

- Take one approved reading in each zone.
- Write each number on the map.

6 Step 6: Build the map — 5 min

- Add both zones to the class key.
- Choose the best zone for one activity.

7 Step 7: Pack the tools — 3 min

- Return each tool to its case.
- Clip all maps together.

8 Step 8: Return inside — 2 min

- Walk back with your weather team.

9 Step 9: Exit check — 3 min

- Write two observations that support your zone choice.

What to turn in

Two mapped zones and one activity recommendation.

No computer? Another way to do it

Use the indoor weather data cards.

Finished early? Next challenge

Weather Shift: Predict which mapped zone would change most after rain, strong wind, or a very sunny afternoon.

Stay safe

Stay inside the announced boundaries, walk between zones, do not touch unknown plants or animals, and use tools only as demonstrated.

Grade targets

Grade 5: Record sun or shade, wind, surface and comfort with symbols.
Grade 6: Add one measured reading if a tool exists. Defend a choice with two observations.

Stuck? Try this order

1. Read the step again, out loud if you can.
2. Ask a partner at your table.
3. Raise your hand. Keep working on the next part while you wait.